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IIIT-Delhi/ Office Orders/2015/2290(A)

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Subject: Reservation norms at IIIT Delhi

The Board of Governors, in its 63rd meeting held on November 28, 2023, has approved the detailed proposal for adopting Reservation Norms at the Institute as at **Annexure E**.

The Reservation Norms include reservation in admissions to various academic programs, Recruitment and promotion, Creation of Equal Opportunity Cell, Appointment of Liaison Officers and a Grievance Mechanism.


(Dr. Deepika Bhaskar)
Registrar

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2. HR Department
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RESERVATION NORMS AT IIIT-DELHI

Educational institutes in India are required to follow national reservation policy of the Government of India for admissions to various programs and recruitment to administrative and academic positions. Some of the educational institutions have adopted flexibility in their approach owing to the specialised nature of their programs, availability of students and manpower in those specialised areas and keeping in mind their autonomy and self-sustenance status.

However, based on the renewed impetus on reservation by the Hon'ble Supreme Court and Government of India, frequent requests for furnishing data regarding reservation status by the government bodies, education department (DTTE), Planning Commission, UGC, SC/ST/OBC/PwD/EWS Commissions as elaborate questionnaires, RTIs, etc., it has become imperative to initiate certain measures in this direction.

IIIT Delhi Act

The IIIT-Delhi is a State university created by an Act (IIIT-Delhi Act 2007) of the Govt of National Capital territory of Delhi in the year of 2008. The Institute is self-sustaining and autonomous for its administration and operations.

As per clause 3(3) of the IIIT Delhi Act, 2007 (Delhi Act, 5 of 2008),

"The Institute shall be financially and administratively autonomous and as such shall be self-sufficient on capital and operational accounts having its own governance as well as administrative policies and practices as prescribed."

As per Clause 18 (d) of the Act, which defines the functions of the Board of Governors (BoG),

"create positions and appoint persons to academics and as well as other posts in the Institute and determine salary structure and terms and conditions of different cadres of employees;"

Reservation implementation does not end with only implementation of the national reservation policy. The institutes are required to devise mechanisms to constantly monitor the progress, provide support to candidates of the reserved categories, make reservation cells, make Grievance Committees specific to reserve categories, appoint Liaison Officers specific for each category (separate for OBC/SC/ST etc), give records of numbers, give fee waivers to reserve category candidates for programs and admission/recruitment applications, appear before relevant Commissions to share data and report handling mechanism, in case of any grievance.

Hence, the implementation of reservation norms at different levels in IIT Delhi requires systematic planning and various steps need to be taken to ensure smooth implementation.

Current Status

IIT Delhi has already implemented national reservation policy for the B.Tech. admissions. It has also announced certain fee waivers for students of economically disadvantaged backgrounds. With limited number of administrative staff, following national reservation policy both at direct recruitment and promotion levels is a challenge but a Committee is currently revising the recruitment rules for administrative staff.

For faculty recruitment and admissions to M.Tech. and Ph.D. programs, considering the highly specialised nature of the programs, finding the right candidates is always a challenge. Implementing reservation policy may lead to many seats remaining vacant which is again a challenge for a self- sustaining institute.

Reservation norms as approved by the Board of Governors, in its 63rd meeting held on 28.11.2023

A. Admissions to various academic programs of the Institute

1. The national reservation policy may continue to be followed for B.Tech. courses as is being currently done.
2. The national reservation policy in admissions will be followed for the M.Tech. programs, adopting the B.Tech. reservation norms and the conversion rule. The reservation to be followed is placed in Appendix I.

In addition, it was also proposed that currently, relaxation is given only in the eligibility criteria, which is extended to the final selection criteria. Here, the cut-off for various reserved categories are to be defined separately to prepare the merit list.

It was also approved to have the same intake as last year for the academic year 2024-25, adopting the reservation. Hence, the proposed intake for the Academic year 2024-25 will be as follows:

(Similar to B.Tech. for regulatory bodies, the intake number for M.Tech. will be excluding the 15% additional seat).

3. For the Ph.D. programs, it is suggested to highlight the relaxation criteria for reserved category appropriately to attract more applicants from the reserve categories and to also mention that candidates from the reserve categories are strongly encouraged to apply. However, the interview and selection norms will continue as per current practice.

B. Recruitment of Administrative Staff through Direct Recruitment and Promotion

The national reservation policy is to be followed for recruitment of administrative staff through direct recruitment as well as for promotion as per government norms. Reservation rosters may be maintained as per reservation norms of the government. Since the reservation can only be applied to vacant posts, the recruitment rules being currently

framed may propose accordingly. However, if a suitable candidate is not found for two consecutive advertisements for a particular reserved post, the post may be de-reserved. Similarly, in case of promotion, if a reserve category candidate is not available for promotion, the norms of de-reservation in promotion may be followed.

C. Faculty Recruitment and Promotion

Faculty recruitment at IIIT Delhi requires candidates from highly specialised areas. It is after many rounds of selection process that a candidate is finally selected. Efforts may be made to find suitable candidates from highly specialised areas belonging to all reserve categories. The relaxation norms of the government for considering reserve category candidates may be followed. Candidates from reserve categories may be strongly encouraged. If it is envisaged that with a little hand holding, the reserve category candidate may deliver as per IIIT-D levels, the candidate may be encouraged and considered, by providing the required support.

D. Creation of an Equal Opportunity Cell that caters to Reservation (SC/ST/OBC/EWS/PwD) and Gender related matters (outside the purview of ICC)

Though the government norms propose a separate reservation cell (SC/ST Cell, OBC Cell etc.) for each category, considering the size of the Institute, a common Equal Opportunity Cell may be established, where activities, sensitization and awareness programmes related to reservation and gender may be carried out. The Cell may provide space for Liaison Officers to hold meetings and listen to grievances, if any. The Equal Opportunity Cell may operate on norms of the government as mentioned for SC/ST Cell, OBC Cell etc. The Equal Opportunity Cell may also function as a Gender Cell for looking into gender sensitization activities, awareness campaigns, gender reservation norms etc. outside the purview of the Internal Complaints Committee.

Terms of Reference of the Equal Opportunity Cell:

1. To function as Reservation Cell of the Institute and carry out sensitization activities.
2. To function as Gender Cell and carry out gender sensitization and gender inclusion activities.
3. To ensure benefits admissible to reserved categories at the Institute.
4. To collect data on various aspects regarding the implementation of the reservation policies as prescribed.
5. To take such follow up measures for achieving the objectives and targets laid down for this purpose.
6. To ensure effective implementation of the reservation policies and programmes.
7. To circulate the decision of the Government on reservation policies.
8. To prepare and analyse reports for onward transmission to various Govt. agencies.

9. To function as a Grievances Redressal Cell for the reservation-related grievances of students and employees of the Institute and render necessary help in solving their academic as well as administrative problems.

E. Liaison Officers for SC/ST/OBC/PwD

As per government mandate, a separate Liaison Officer for each reserve category is to be appointed by the Institute along with a Reservation Committee which may include members of faculty, staff and students and Liaison officers.

Hence, it is proposed that a Reservation Committee having Liaison Officers of each category may be formed. The duties of the Liaison Officer will be as per prescribed government norms. Other members may be invited, as required.

F. Grievance Mechanism

As per government norms, a Grievance Mechanism for redressal of complaints/grievances of students/employees of reserve categories needs to be put in place. The grievances and their resolution is, generally, required to be reported to the respective Commissions.

It is proposed that the Reservation Committee may be empowered to look into such grievances and help resolve them.

Appendix I

Reservation

In category

- a) Scheduled Castes (SC): 15 % of the total seats.
- b) Scheduled Tribes (ST): 7.5% of the total seats.
- c) Other Backward Classes (OBC-NCL): 27% of the total seats.
- d) Economically Weaker Section (EWS): 10% of total seats

Sub – category

- e) Defence Category(CW): 5% of the total seats in each category are reserved for candidates belonging to the 'Defence Category' in various priority. (Will be similar to B.Tech)
- f) Differently-Abled Persons (PD): 5% of the total seats in each category are reserved for candidates belonging to the 'Differently Abled Person’

Relaxation

Scheduled Castes (SC) and Scheduled Tribes (ST): A relaxation of 10% marks in the eligibility requirements for the seats reserved for them.

Defence (CW): A relaxation of 5% marks in the eligibility requirements for the seats reserved for them.

Persons with Disability (PWD): A relaxation of 5% marks in the eligibility requirements for the seats reserved for them.

OBC: A relaxation of 5% marks in the eligibility requirements for the seats reserved for them.

Note: No relaxation for EWS.

Conversion of Seats:

In the case of categories (a) and (b) of SC and ST, the vacant seats are interchangeable. If the merit list is exhausted for SC & ST, then the vacancies will be treated as unreserved.

If sufficient numbers of eligible candidates from the categories mentioned in (c) and (d) are NOT available, the vacancies will be treated as unreserved.

Seats under category (f) are interchangeable within the category if sufficient candidates are not available in a particular sub-category.

In case a sufficient number of eligible candidates from the categories mentioned in (e) and (f) above are not available, the vacancies will be treated as unreserved in the respective category.

Note: The conversion of seats will be made in the round where the merit list is exhausted in the respective category.